

What can we learn from school closure reversals?

12 selected reprieves. 4 closure comparisons. 8 exhibits.

Selected cases reveal questions to test, not odds of success.

This catalogue does not establish a national survival rate. It brings together documented cases to identify evidence and mechanisms worth testing for Kew Riverside. It is not an exhaustive list or proof that a campaign tactic causes success.

First effort: a testable alternative and an audit of the assumptions.

Fletching shows how evidenced funding and a revised budget can change an early decision. St John the Divine shows the value of testing family destinations and the receiving school's finances. A procedural reprieve can create time, but Hazlewood shows why the underlying problem still needs a solution.

All 12 schools are listed open in GIAS at the research cutoff, including Pooles Park's academy successor. This does not establish financial recovery or protection from a fresh proposal.

How to use this report

- Eight exhibits cover reprieves, efforts that did not prevent closure, and practical priorities.
- Four closure comparisons distinguish what was tried, the recorded assessment and any partial benefit.
- The complete citations appendix includes 45 sources, full URLs, precise locators and a claim ledger.

Research cutoff: 22 September 2026. Suggested priorities are editorial synthesis. Parent-led research; no school or council endorsement is implied.

Closure proposals can stop at several stages

12 selected English schools, 2019-2026; 9 grouped decision episodes across 6 local authorities.

Initial consultation

Fletching; Godshill; St George’s, Langton
Closest stage to Kew Riverside today



3 schools

Local decision after notice

Brading; Oakfield; Wroxall
Three schools in one Cabinet episode



3 schools

External intervention

Arreton; St John the Divine; Fenstanton;
Also Holy Trinity, Pooles Park and Hazlewood



6 schools

Selected historical outcomes, not the odds of success.

This catalogue cannot estimate Kew’s probability of remaining open.

Sources: S01-S16; GIAS status checks on 22 September 2026. See data/catalogue.json and the source register.

Unit: school. External interventions have different eligibility rules. “Open” does not establish financial recovery.

What the decision records actually say

A qualitative evidence matrix; linked schools are grouped to avoid counting one episode several times.

	Schools	Process / authority	Pupil / cost evidence	Funding / delivery	Community impact	Rural protection	Institutional partner
Fletching	1	-	■	■	○	○	■
Godshill	1	-	-	-	■	■	-
Brading / Oakfield / Wroxall	3	○	○	-	○	○	○
Arreton St George's	1	■	■	-	■	■	○
St John the Divine	1	■	■	○	○	-	○
Fenstanton / Holy Trinity	2	■	○	○	-	-	○
Pooles Park	1	-	■	■	■	-	■
St George's, Langton	1	○	○	-	○	-	○
Hazlewood	1	■	■	-	-	-	○

■ Explicit rationale ○ Discussed / route only - Not established

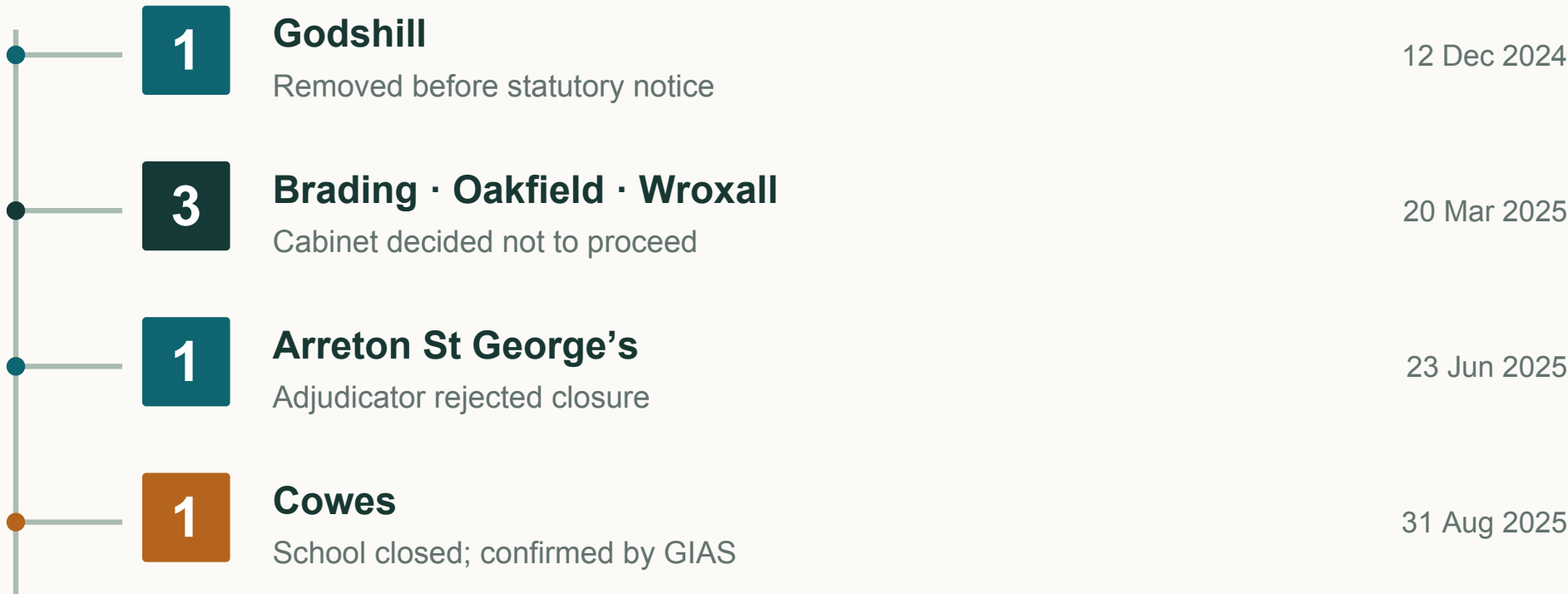
Sources: S01-S16. Cell-level rationale and source IDs: data/catalogue.json, reason_episodes.

One analyst's coding; no matched failures or causal estimates. St George's outcome uses attributed reporting. Unknown is not "no".

Six schools. Four routes through one local programme.

The six schools named in the Isle of Wight’s 2024 closure programme, followed through August 2025.

6 schools originally proposed for closure



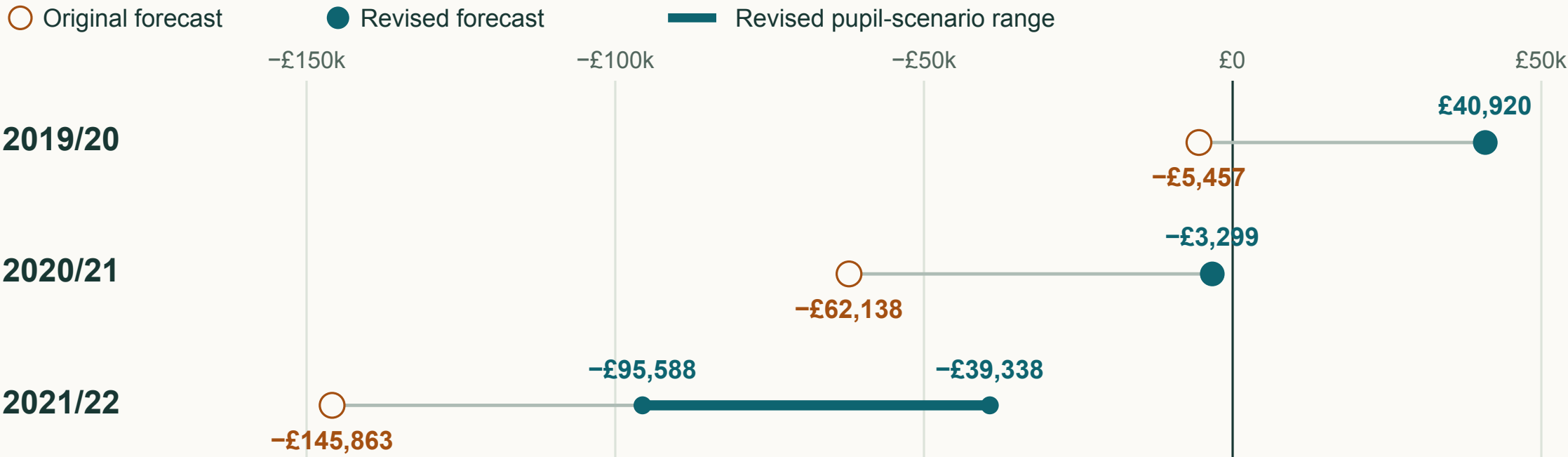
Five proposals stopped; one school closed. This is a bounded local comparison, not a national rate.

Sources: S03-S07, S28 and G12. Five retained schools listed open in GIAS on 22 September 2026.

Unit: original school proposal. Sequence is not drawn to a time scale. Long-term finances and future reviews are separate questions.

A stronger forecast is not yet a sustainable budget

Fletching | December 2019 forecasts of year-end balance, in pounds. These are not actual results.



SUPPORT REPORTED IN THE PLAN

£44,368

Fundraising raised

Reported cash raised

£20,000

Trust pledge

A commitment, not cash received

£10,000

Parish resolution

A resolution, not cash received

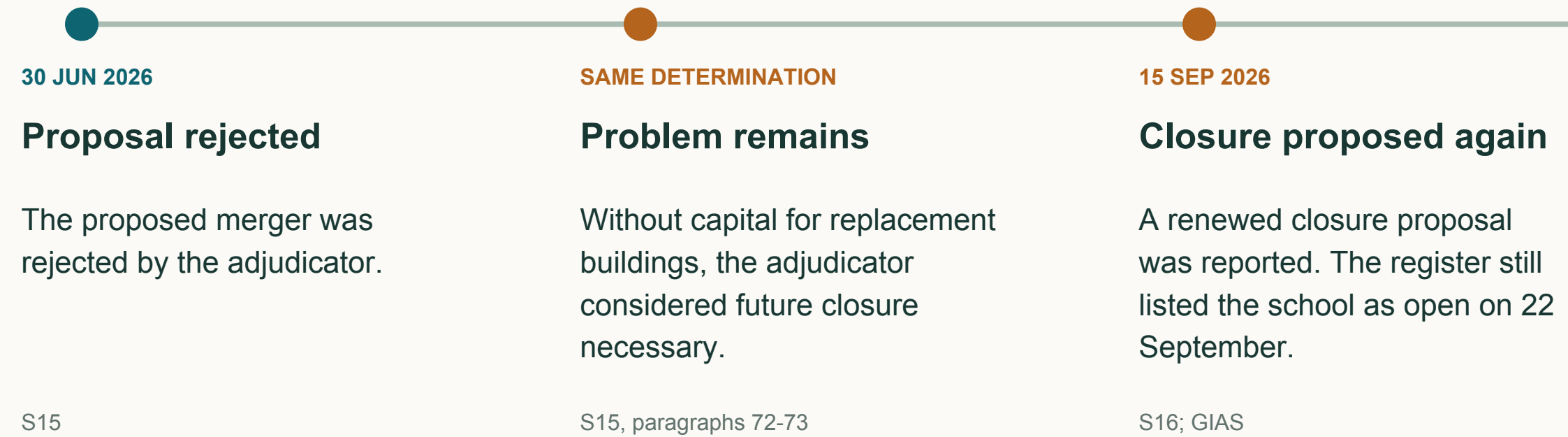
£74,368 raised or committed in total. Later deficits remained in both pupil scenarios.

Sources: S01 sections 3.10 and 7.3; S02 confirms the December 2019 decision to stop consultation.

Budget changes also reflect other assumptions. The range is not a confidence interval. No Kew funding target is implied.

Stopping a proposal is only the first milestone

Hazlewood shows why a rejected proposal and a lasting turnaround need separate labels.



Track two outcomes separately

1 Has this proposal stopped?

2 Is continuing provision sustainable?

Sources: STP663 (S15); BBC follow-up syndicated by Yahoo on 15 September 2026 (S16); GIAS URN 108610.

Hazlewood remains in the historical reprieve catalogue, with the renewed threat stated. No prediction of eventual closure is made here.

Turn support into evidence a decision-maker can use

A suggested work plan for Kew Riverside. Editorial synthesis, not a ranking of proven effectiveness.

START NOW

Cost an operating alternative

Three-year budget; staffing, pupil scenarios and evidenced funding.

Test the closure assumptions

Pupil forecasts, likely family destinations and net savings, including PFI.

IN PARALLEL

Document effects on families

Aggregated journeys, SEND continuity and community use; protect identities.

Prepare the official response

Numbered sources, a costed alternative and specific questions to answer.

IF A SPECIFIC ISSUE IS EVIDENCED

Check the process and the available remedy.

Keep a dated decision log; check the current rules and who is eligible to use each route.

Case basis: Fletching (S01); Arreton (S07); St John the Divine (S08); Pooles Park (S11); current guidance (S17-S18).

Kew is a community school. Historic faith-school referrals and rural protections are not automatic routes for Kew families.

When an alternative did not keep a school open

Four selected comparisons. Recorded assessments are attributed; these cases do not measure tactic effectiveness.

Cowes

Closed 31 Aug 2025

WHAT WAS TRIED

479 online signatures; councillor representation.

ASSESSMENT IN THE RECORD

Notice: falling rolls and surplus places. Cabinet approved closure.

S05, S27-S29, G12

Broad Oak

Closed 31 Aug 2020

WHAT WAS TRIED

Two classes, shared leadership and a federation budget.

ASSESSMENT IN THE RECORD

Council: later deficit, leadership gaps and insufficient evidence for extra pupils.

S24, G13

St Bartholomew's

Extra term; closed 31 Dec 2024

WHAT WAS TRIED

Smaller-school plan, external referral and transition arguments.

ASSESSMENT IN THE RECORD

Adjudicators accepted closure grounds, but allowed more transition time.

S23, G14

De Beauvoir

Closed 31 Aug 2024

WHAT WAS TRIED

Alternative merger pairings; opposition to the wider package.

ASSESSMENT IN THE RECORD

Council: distance and stabilising rolls limited the suggested alternatives.

S25-S26, S30, G15

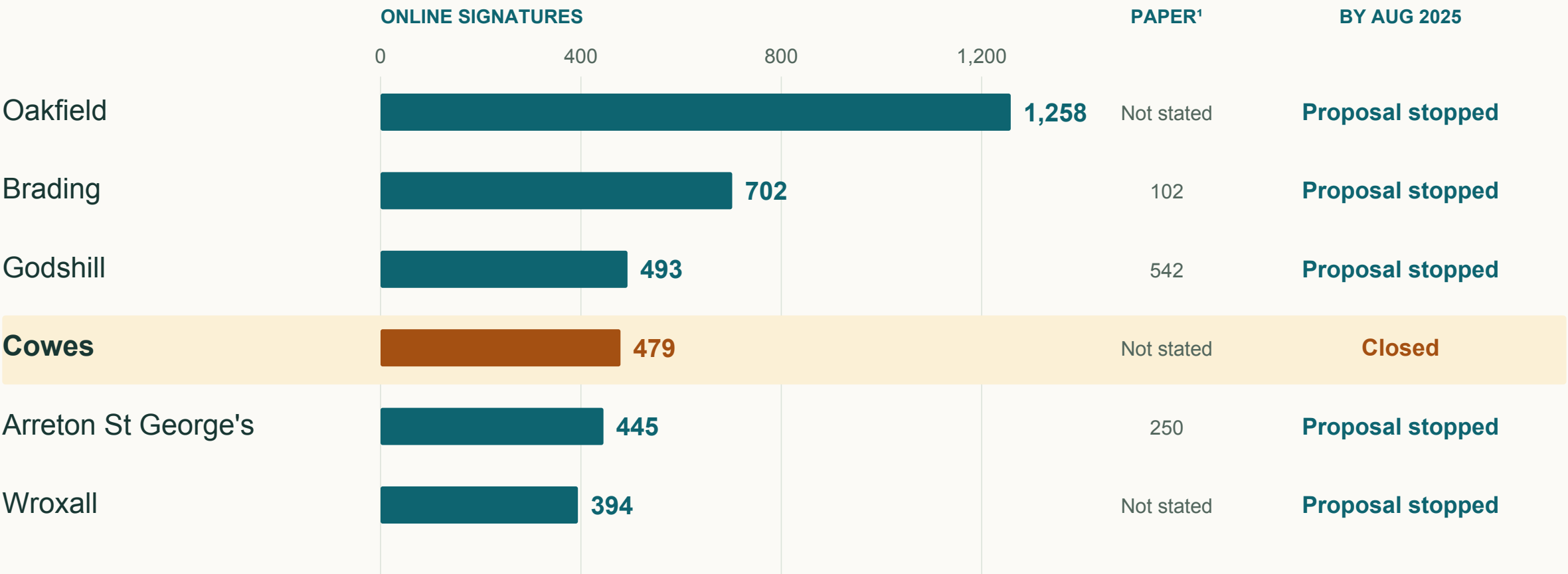
A concession still matters: St Bartholomew's gained an extra term to support transition.

Full efforts, exact source locations, outcomes and limitations are in the closure comparisons and citations appendix.

These are contextual comparisons, not matched controls. "Did not prevent closure" does not mean "had no benefit".

Petition counts do not reveal a success threshold

All six original Isle of Wight proposals | Autumn 2024 signatures reported to Cabinet in March 2025.



¹ Paper and online counts stay separate: overlap is unknown.

Use mobilisation to recruit evidence, expertise and commitments for a workable alternative.

Counts: S27 paragraph 92 (PDF p25). Outcomes: S03, S05, S07, S28 and G12. Online total: 3,771.

Historical snapshot, not final petition totals. No adjustment for school size, campaign duration or signatory residence.

Cases 1-2 of 12

Fletching Church of England Primary School

East Sussex | 2019-12-23 | Initial consultation

Outcome: Consultation halted

The council's recommendation relied on an improved short-term budget, a largely maintained roll and the diocese's position. Its subsequent admissions report confirms that closure did not proceed.

Application to Kew: Give the council a revised budget with evidenced funding and realistic pupil assumptions.

Limit: The council still expected recurring deficits and did not validate long-term recovery.

Open in GIAS on 22 September 2026.

S01 | S02 | [GIAS 114503](#)

S01 sections 3.10, 6.4 and 7.1-7.6; S02 section 2.3

Godshill Primary School

Isle of Wight | 2024-12-12 | Initial consultation

Outcome: Removed before statutory notice

Cabinet retained the school, citing community interests, the rural-school presumption and earlier decisions concerning Chillerton and Godshill.

Application to Kew: Tie community evidence to the decision criteria and the council's previous commitments.

Limit: The rural-school protection does not automatically apply to Kew Riverside.

Open in GIAS on 22 September 2026.

S03 | S04 | [GIAS 118159](#)

December Cabinet outcome; S04 response explaining Godshill's removal

Cases 3-4 of 12

Brading Church of England Controlled Primary School

Isle of Wight | 2025-03-20 | Local decision after statutory notice

Outcome: Closure not pursued

Cabinet voted not to proceed. Published minutes record scrutiny and questions about costs and data, but do not isolate the reason for this school's outcome.

Application to Kew: Prepare evidence that members can use in scrutiny and the final decision.

Limit: A campaign's presence does not establish that it caused the vote.

Open in GIAS on 22 September 2026.

S05 | GIAS 118182

Cabinet item 101a and item 104

Oakfield Church of England Aided Primary School, Ryde

Isle of Wight | 2025-03-20 | Local decision after statutory notice

Outcome: Closure not pursued

Cabinet voted not to proceed. The minutes document the outcome without a school-specific causal explanation.

Application to Kew: Use a clear evidence brief alongside formal participation.

Limit: Shares a Cabinet episode with Brading and Wroxall; not an independent replication.

Open in GIAS on 22 September 2026.

S05 | S06 | GIAS 118193

S05 Cabinet item 101a; S06 account of the diocesan challenge

Cases 5-6 of 12

Wroxall Primary School

Isle of Wight | 2025-03-20 | Local decision after statutory notice

Outcome: Closure not pursued

Cabinet voted not to proceed. The minutes do not attribute that decision to a particular intervention.

Application to Kew: Identify what evidence decision-makers need before the vote.

Limit: The council said further school-place reviews would still be needed.

Open in GIAS on 22 September 2026.

S05 | GIAS 118173

Cabinet items 101a and 104

Arreton St George's Church of England (Aided) Primary School

Isle of Wight | 2025-06-23 | External intervention

Outcome: Closure rejected by adjudicator

The adjudicators rejected the proposal because significant procedural flaws could have affected the outcome and the rural community impact had not been properly considered.

Application to Kew: Audit the selection method, evidence and community-impact assessment.

Limit: The ruling stopped this proposal; it did not establish permanent financial viability.

Open in GIAS on 22 September 2026.

S07 | S06 | GIAS 118180

STP661, paragraphs 132-133 and preceding analysis

Cases 7-8 of 12

St John the Divine Church of England Primary School

Lambeth | 2025-06-24 | External intervention

Outcome: Closure/merger proposal rejected

The adjudicator found deficiencies in the process and insufficient evidence that pupil transfers would produce a sustainable receiving school.

Application to Kew: Test actual family preferences and the financial consequences of pupil movement.

Limit: Mixed-age classes were discussed as a possible option, not an approved recovery plan. Long-term sustainability remained uncertain.

Open in GIAS on 22 September 2026.

S08 | S09 | GIAS 100614

STP659, paragraphs 44-61 and 68

Fenstanton Primary School

Lambeth | 2025-07-17 | External intervention

Outcome: Closure proposal rejected

The adjudicators rejected the closure and related amalgamation proposals because the decisions and procedures were unlawful.

Application to Kew: Keep a dated record of proposals, conditions, decisions and who has authority to make them.

Limit: The alternative merger was also rejected. The result did not validate its business case or establish a general parental appeal right.

Open in GIAS on 22 September 2026.

S10 | GIAS 100595

STP662, paragraphs 29-39

Cases 9-10 of 12

Holy Trinity Church of England Primary School, Tulse Hill

Lambeth | 2025-07-17 | External intervention

Outcome: Closure proposal rejected

The same adjudication left both Holy Trinity and Fenstanton open after rejecting the linked proposals.

Application to Kew: Check process and decision authority alongside any alternative proposal.

Limit: This is one shared adjudication with Fenstanton, not a second independent success.

Open in GIAS on 22 September 2026.

S10 | GIAS 100622

STP662, paragraphs 29-39

Pooles Park Primary School

Islington | 2023-11-14 | External intervention

Outcome: Academy route retained; provision continued

The minister retained the academy order. The recorded rationale was a willing sponsor, a viable academy model and additional SEND provision and community benefits.

Application to Kew: An alternative needs a capable organisation willing to deliver it.

Limit: The school changed governance. Its academy-order circumstances cannot be assumed for Kew.

Academy successor open in GIAS on 22 September 2026.

S11 | S12 | GIAS 150522

2024 High Court judgment, paragraphs 1 and 52-53; GIAS successor URN 150522

Cases 11-12 of 12

St George's Church of England Primary School, Langton Matravers

Dorset | 2026-06-26 | Initial consultation

Outcome: Consultation stopped; two-year reprieve reported

News reports quote the trust ending consultation following feedback and ruling out structural changes in 2026/27 and 2027/28.

Application to Kew: Use early consultation to expose unanswered questions and seek a clear written response.

Limit: Outcome relies on attributed reporting. Objections about process are not independent findings of illegality; long-term options remained under review.

Open in GIAS on 22 September 2026.

S13 | S14 | GIAS 150428

Trust statements reported 26-27 June 2026

Hazlewood Community Primary School

North Tyneside | 2026-06-30 | External intervention

Outcome: Merger rejected; renewed closure proposal reported

The adjudicator rejected the proposed merger but found that, without replacement-building capital, the school should eventually close.

Application to Kew: A procedural reprieve needs a plan for the underlying capital or operating problem.

Limit: A renewed closure proposal was reported on 15 September 2026. This is not a demonstrated lasting turnaround.

Open in GIAS on 22 September 2026; renewed proposal reported.

S15 | S16 | GIAS 108610

STP663, paragraphs 67-74; BBC syndicated report 15 September 2026

Cowes Primary School

Isle of Wight | Community school | Closed 2025-08-31

Closure approved by Cabinet; GIAS confirms closure on 31 August 2025.

What was tried

- An online petition to save the school had 479 signatures in the council's reported initial-consultation snapshot. [S27](#)
- The local councillor spoke on behalf of Cowes Primary at the Cabinet meeting before leaving the room for the decision. [S05](#)

Why closure proceeded, according to the record

The statutory notice cited declining pupil numbers at Cowes and significant surplus places in its planning area. Cabinet approved closure. The minutes do not establish the marginal effect of the petition or the councillor's intervention.

What changed

No specific concession attributable to these efforts is established in the reviewed sources.

Application to Kew - editorial inference

Mobilisation and political representation do not by themselves establish that the place-planning case has changed. Link support to verifiable demand, costs and a deliverable alternative.

Comparison

Same initial six-school programme as Godshill, Brading, Oakfield, Wroxall and Arreton. This is contextual comparison, not a controlled experiment.

Limits

The signature count is a historical report snapshot, not the final campaign total or a count of affected families. No conclusion about what would have happened without the campaign is possible.

[S05](#) | [S27](#) | [S28](#) | [S29](#) | [G12](#)

S05 item 101a; S27 paragraph 92; S29 paragraphs 2-3; S28 action taken; G12 closure date

Broad Oak Community Primary School

East Sussex | Community school | Closed 2020-08-31

March 2020 report recommended closure after examining the governors' alternative; GIAS confirms closure on 31 August 2020.

What was tried

- Governors submitted a plan for two classes, restructured leadership and a pooled three-school federation budget. [S24](#)
- The plan sought to build enrolment from 40-plus to 70-plus pupils during the next academic year. [S24](#)

Why closure proceeded, according to the record

The council's report found the pooled budget would still reach a £33,894 deficit in 2021/22. It questioned leadership capacity, absence cover and contingency, and regarded the extra-pupil target as insufficiently evidenced.

What changed

The governors' plan received a documented financial and operational assessment; this is not proof of an outcome concession.

Application to Kew - editorial inference

Stress-test an alternative at both school and partner level: pupil recruitment, staffing, reserves, absence cover and the later years all need evidence.

Comparison

Same authority and rural-school review period as Fletching. Fletching's proposal stopped in December 2019; Broad Oak's plan was assessed later and closure proceeded. The cases differ in finances, school type and education concerns.

Limits

The report gives the council's assessment of the alternative, not an independent forecast audit. Its concerns must not be recast as proof that federation or mixed-age teaching generally fails.

[S24](#) | [G13](#)

S24 sections 12.1-12.13, 14-15; G13 closure date

St Bartholomew's CofE Primary School

Brighton and Hove | Voluntary aided school | Closed 2024-12-31

Adjudicators approved closure with a one-term extension, from 31 August to 31 December 2024. GIAS confirms the later closure date.

What was tried

- The school proposed reducing its admission number to 20 with staffing changes, and raised federation and phased closure as alternatives. [S23](#)
- Governors referred the decision to the adjudicator. The school and diocese argued for more time to support vulnerable pupils' transition. [S23](#)

Why closure proceeded, according to the record

The adjudicators accepted the demographic need to reduce places and considered the deficit, low pupil numbers and concerns over a smaller school's delivery. They found the transition arrangements insufficiently developed for some vulnerable children and extended the timetable.

What changed

One extra school term for transition, explicitly justified by the adjudicators. This is a meaningful concession, not a lasting reprieve.

Application to Kew - editorial inference

A challenge may improve transition without preserving the school. Keep the case for a sustainable school and the case for protecting children during any transition explicit.

Comparison

The same broad external-adjudication route produced rejection at St John the Divine and approval with modification here. Different evidence and circumstances prevent attributing the difference to campaign quality.

Limits

The determination records the school as saying the diocese did not wish to pursue federation. Do not describe an agreed or funded federation as having been tested and failed.

[S23](#) | [G14](#)

S23 paragraphs 2-3, 47-49 and 79-91; G14 closure date

De Beauvoir Primary School

Hackney | Community school | Closed 2024-08-31

Cabinet agreed closure in December 2023; GIAS confirms closure on 31 August 2024.

What was tried

- Consultation produced alternative merger pairings involving De Beauvoir, including Randal Cremer and Princess May. [S25](#)
- Across the whole Hackney package, 95% of responses that could be clearly assessed opposed the proposals. This is a programme-wide figure, not a De Beauvoir-only result. [S30](#)

Why closure proceeded, according to the record

The council rejected suggested pairings on grounds including walking distance and whether pupil numbers would stabilise. It maintained that the underlying demand and sustainability problem remained despite extensive opposition.

What changed

No specific reprieve or transition concession attributable to these submissions is established in the reviewed sources.

Application to Kew - editorial inference

Specify a willing partner, viable combined rolls and a workable site and journey plan. Treat consultation support as evidence to accompany that proposition, not a vote that decides closure.

Comparison

An urban community-school closure offers context for Kew. It is not matched on school finances, local geography or pupil demand.

Limits

The 95% figure is neither a representative public-opinion poll nor a school-specific percentage. The council's objections to these particular mergers do not show that all partnership options fail. [S25](#) section 4.27 gives 207 opposed and 12 supportive proposal-level responses (219 clear responses, from a process receiving 175 submissions). A respondent could comment on several proposals; these are not 219 unique people.

[S25](#) | [S26](#) | [S30](#) | [G15](#)

[S25](#) sections 4.24-4.28 and 7.10-7.15; [S26](#) overview of decision; [S30](#) consultation summary; [G15](#) closure date

COMPARING OUTCOMES

Test the evidence behind the alternative

A financial alternative

Reprieve: Fletching: revised budget and evidenced support helped stop the initial proposal.

Closure comparison: Broad Oak: a revised federation budget still ran into deficit; leadership and recruitment assumptions were challenged.

Evidence to build: Test every year of the plan and show credible staffing, reserves, pupil demand and partner commitments.

S01 | S02 | S24 | G13

External challenge

Reprieve: St John the Divine: closure was rejected after scrutiny of process and the receiving school's viability.

Closure comparison: St Bartholomew's: closure was approved, with an extra term for vulnerable pupils' transition.

Evidence to build: Tie each challenge to a specific defect and its practical remedy. A delay and a lasting reprieve are different outcomes.

S08 | S23 | G14

Public mobilisation

Reprieve: Five Isle of Wight proposals stopped after petitions were recorded.

Closure comparison: Cowes also had a petition, and a councillor spoke on its behalf; it closed.

Evidence to build: Use mobilisation to recruit evidence, expertise and commitments. These observations do not measure whether petitions helped.

S03 | S05 | S07 | S27 | S28 | G12

These are contextual comparisons chosen to expose useful questions. They are not a matched control group, and the differences do not identify a campaign tactic's causal effect.

METHOD AND INTERPRETATION

What this evidence can support

Selection

A purposive catalogue of 12 English state-funded primary schools with a documented stopped closure or merger proposal, 2019-2026, alongside four selected closure comparisons. These cases are not a national census, a representative sample or a matched control group. They cannot estimate a survival rate or the effectiveness of a campaign tactic.

Outcome definition

A named closure/site-merger proposal stopped or provision continued through an academy successor. A reprieve is not the same as improved academic results, restored enrolment or a sustainable budget.

Counting

Stage charts count 12 schools. The reasons matrix groups linked decisions into 9 episodes. The three Isle of Wight Cabinet outcomes and the two-school Lambeth adjudication are grouped; other local episodes remain related. Cowes is outside the reprieve set and completes the six-school local cohort.

Evidence

Eleven schools have primary decision/recommendation or judgment evidence. St George's relies on reports quoting the trust. Pooles Park's judgment was inspected through indexed text because direct retrieval was blocked. GIAS statuses were checked directly for all 12.

Coding

One analyst coded overlapping themes. Filled squares mean an explicit decision/recommendation rationale. Open circles mean discussed or part of the route. Dashes mean not established in the reviewed record, not absent. No independent second coding was performed.

Inference

The four closure comparisons were added purposively after the reprieve research. This is not a matched control group; there is still no national denominator or common follow-up horizon. No national survival rate, tactic effectiveness or Kew-specific odds can be estimated.

APPLICATION AND DATA NOTES

Turn lessons into school-specific evidence

1. Cost a smaller, sustainable school

Three-year budget; staffing and class options; low, central and high pupil scenarios; confirmed bridge funding and delivery partner.

Case basis: Fletching; Pooles Park; St John the Divine. Suggested timing: Start now.

2. Audit demand and the net saving

Traceable pupil forecasts, family destination evidence, transition costs and continuing building/PFI costs.

Case basis: St John the Divine; Arreton. Suggested timing: Start now.

3. Document what families would lose

Aggregated evidence on journeys, SEND continuity, nursery/community use and parental preferences; no public personal data.

Case basis: Godshill; Arreton; Pooles Park. Suggested timing: Alongside.

4. Turn support into formal evidence

Concise consultation submission with numbered evidence, costed alternatives and questions requiring answers; coordinate with governors.

Case basis: Fletching; Isle of Wight cases. Suggested timing: Alongside.

5. Check process and available remedies

Dated decision log and specific procedural concerns; assess school-type eligibility before relying on a referral route.

Case basis: Fenstanton / Holy Trinity; Hazlewood. Suggested timing: If evidenced.

Current process and school type

Current DfE guidance applies from 1 September 2026. Kew Riverside is a community school. Historic faith-school referral routes and rural protections should not be assumed to apply. The proposal page describes the initial consultation stage. Check the applicable route before relying on a later remedy. [S17-S18, S21-S22]

Fletching financial exhibit

Values are forecasts as reported in December 2019, not outturn. The later interval is a pupil-scenario range, not a confidence interval. Support combines cash raised and pledges/resolutions. The total forecast change is not attributable to fundraising alone. [S01]

Source register and claim ledger

45 source records. 49 evidence and interpretation entries.

Every source used in the pack is listed on the following pages with its full URL, publication or record date, access date, locator, inspection method and the IDs of the claims it supports. The register covers this pack; it is not a bibliography of every school closure.

Reading the identifiers

S = source document; G = establishment-register source. R = reprieve case; G-R = register follow-up claim; F = closure comparison; E = effort; X = exhibit; L = editorial lesson; CTX = Kew context; H = Hackney denominator.

The claim ledger follows the source register. Each entry gives the proposition or interpretation, the source IDs and the exact location or data field. Recommendations are explicitly labelled editorial inferences.

Inspection limits

Primary reports and determinations carry more weight than a campaign or council press account. Pooles Park's judgment was inspected through indexed text because direct retrieval was blocked. St George's, Langton relies on attributed reporting. Inspection methods are recorded individually; publication dates are taken from the documents where available. At the 22 September integration check, 42 of 45 source URLs were retrievable; Isle of Wight sources S04, S05 and S28 returned HTTP 403. Their earlier recorded inspection is retained, without claiming a fresh document recheck.

Offline companion files

citations-appendix.html provides clickable source anchors and a readable claim ledger.
citations-appendix.md is editable. data/sources.json and data/claims.json support reuse and checking.
Public third-party documents are linked rather than redistributed.

COMPLETE CITATIONS APPENDIX / SOURCES

Sources S01-S30 and G01-G15

S01: Fletching closure consultation: report to Lead Member, 23 December 2019

East Sussex County Council. Primary council report.

Published / record date: 2019-12-23. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Sections 3.10, 6.4 and 7.1-7.6

Inspection: Direct PDF retrieval and text inspection

<https://democracy.eastsussex.gov.uk/documents/s28518/Item%20-%20Fletching%20CE%20Primary%20School.pdf>

Used in: R01, X01, X02, X04, X06, L01

S02: Admission arrangements 2021-22: confirmation that Fletching closure did not proceed

East Sussex County Council. Primary council report.

Published / record date: 2020-02-24. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Section 2.3

Inspection: Web page / indexed source text inspected

<https://democracy.eastsussex.gov.uk/documents/s29315/Lead%20Member%2024%2002%2020%20Admission%20Arrangements%202021%20-%202022%20FINALamended.pdf>

Used in: R01, X01, X02, X04, L01

S03: Cabinet minutes, 12 December 2024

Isle of Wight Council. Primary minutes.

Published / record date: 2024-12-12. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: School Place Planning / Godshill

Inspection: Web page / indexed source text inspected

<https://iow.moderngov.co.uk/documents/g2073/Public%2Bminutes%2B12th-Dec-2024%2B17.00%2BCabinet.pdf?T=11>

Used in: R02, X01, X02, X03, X08, L03

S04: General consultation responses: explanation of Godshill decision

Isle of Wight Council. Primary council response.

Published / record date: 2025 programme; online version checked 2026-09-22. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Council response: retaining Godshill, rural presumption and previous Chillerton/Godshill decisions

Inspection: Web page / indexed source text inspected

https://www.iow.gov.uk/media/2552/Download-general-responses-appendix/pdf/Appendix_2_-_General_Consultation_Responses_reviewed_Redacted.pdf?m=1770032808753

Used in: R02, X01, X02

Source register continued

S05: Cabinet decision and minutes, 20 March 2025

Isle of Wight Council. Primary decision/minutes.

Published / record date: 2025-03-20. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Items 101a and 104

Inspection: Web page / indexed source text inspected

<https://iow.moderngov.co.uk/ieListDocuments.aspx?CId=145&MId=2305&Ver=4>

Used in: R03, R04, R05, F01, F01-E2, X01, X02, X03, X07, X08, L03

S06: Adjudicator rules that Arreton school should remain open

Diocese of Portsmouth. Primary participant account; interested party.

Published / record date: 2025-06-23. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Six-school programme and diocesan challenge

Inspection: Web page / indexed source text inspected

<https://www.portsmouth.anglican.org/news/2025/06/23/adjudicator-rules-arreton-school-should-remain-open/>

Used in: R04, R06, X01, X02, X03

S07: STP661: Arreton St George's CE Primary School

Office of the Schools Adjudicator. Primary determination.

Published / record date: 2025-06-23. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Paragraphs 132-133; preceding procedural and community analysis

Inspection: Direct PDF retrieval and text inspection

https://assets.publishing.service.gov.uk/media/685e6effc2633bd820a92b1d/STP661_Arreton_St_George_s_CE_Primary_School_Isle_of_Wight_23_June_2025.pdf

Used in: R06, X01, X02, X03, X06, X08, L03

S08: STP659: St John the Divine CE Primary School

Office of the Schools Adjudicator. Primary determination.

Published / record date: 2025-06-24. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Paragraphs 44-61 and 68

Inspection: Direct PDF retrieval and text inspection

https://assets.publishing.service.gov.uk/media/685d0843c779b80d9a0e1069/STP659_St_John_the_Divine_CE_Primary_School.pdf

Used in: R07, X01, X02, X06, L02

Source register continued

S09: Response to the Office of the School Adjudicator's decision

Lambeth Council. Primary council response.

Published / record date: 2025-06-26. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: St John the Divine referral and rejected proposal

Inspection: Web page / indexed source text inspected

<https://love.lambeth.gov.uk/lambeth-response-to-the-office-of-the-school-adjudicators-decision/>

Used in: R07, X01, X02

S10: STP662: Fenstanton and Holy Trinity CofE Primary Schools

Office of the Schools Adjudicator. Primary determination.

Published / record date: 2025-07-17. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Paragraphs 29-39

Inspection: Direct PDF retrieval and text inspection

<https://assets.publishing.service.gov.uk/media/68790744760bf6cedaf5be67/stp662-fenstanton-primary-school-and-holy-trinity-ofe-primary-school-determination-17-july-2025.pdf>

Used in: R08, R09, X01, X02

S11: R (Islington) v Secretary of State for Education [2024] EWHC 1798 (Admin)

High Court; reproduced by BAILII. Primary judgment; search-index text inspected, direct fetch blocked.

Published / record date: 2024-07-12. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Paragraphs 1, 52-53 (ministerial decision of 14 November 2023)

Inspection: Search-index judgment text; direct fetch blocked. No local judgment copy verified.

<https://www.bailii.org/ew/cases/EWHC/Admin/2024/1798.html>

Used in: R10, X01, X02, X06

S12: Pooles Park academy successor: establishment record

Department for Education, GIAS. Primary register.

Published / record date: Checked 2026-09-22. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Status and linked establishments; URN 150522

Inspection: Direct GIAS HTML retrieval

<https://get-information-schools.service.gov.uk/Establishments/Establishment/Details/150522>

Used in: R10, G-R10, X01, X02

Source register continued

S13: Threat of closure lifted from Langton Matravers village school

Swanage News. Secondary local reporting quoting trust.

Published / record date: 2026-06-27. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Trust statement withdrawing consultation on 26 June 2026

Inspection: Web page / indexed source text inspected

<https://www.swanage.news/threat-of-closure-lifted-from-langton-matravers-village-school/>

Used in: R11, X01, X02

S14: Primary school closure plans halted after backlash

BBC reporting syndicated by AOL. Secondary reporting quoting trust.

Published / record date: 2026-06-26. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: No structural changes planned for 2026/27 or 2027/28

Inspection: Web page / indexed source text inspected

<https://www.aol.com/articles/primary-school-closure-plans-halted-105408000.html>

Used in: R11, X01, X02

S15: STP663: Hazlewood and Greenfields Primary Schools

Office of the Schools Adjudicator. Primary determination.

Published / record date: 2026-06-30. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Paragraphs 67-74; school-type label differs between OSA landing page and GIAS

Inspection: Direct PDF retrieval and text inspection

https://assets.publishing.service.gov.uk/media/6a44f5566c5c6d8122b815d4/STP663_Hazlewood_and_Greenfields_Primary_School_North_Tyneside_30_June_2026.pdf

Used in: R12, X01, X02, X05

S16: Primary school faces closure for second time

BBC reporting syndicated by Yahoo. Secondary follow-up.

Published / record date: 2026-09-15. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Renewed Hazlewood closure proposal reported

Inspection: Web page / indexed source text inspected

<https://nz.news.yahoo.com/primary-school-faces-closure-second-162454532.html>

Used in: R12, X01, X02, X05

Source register continued

S17: Closing maintained schools: current statutory guidance

Department for Education. Primary statutory guidance.

Published / record date: 2026-05. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Pages 15-18 and 21-23; applicable from 1 September 2026

Inspection: Web page / indexed source text inspected

https://assets.publishing.service.gov.uk/media/6a034409e71c4cdf4026bab8/Closing_maintained_schools_guidance_-_May_2026.pdf

Used in: X06, CTX

S18: School organisation guidance: applicability and updates

Department for Education. Primary guidance landing page.

Published / record date: 2026-09-03. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Details and 3 September 2026 update

Inspection: Web page / indexed source text inspected

<https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/school-organisation-local-authority-maintained-schools>

Used in: X06, CTX

S19: Kew Riverside consultation and supporting papers

Richmond Council. Primary proposal.

Published / record date: 2026-09; context checked 2026-09-22. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Council consultation; read alongside S20 and S21

Inspection: Web page / indexed source text inspected

https://www.richmond.gov.uk/services/children_and_family_care/schools_and_colleges/school_organisation_consultations/kew_riverside_consultation

Used in: CTX

S20: Kew Riverside consultation leaflet

Richmond Council. Primary proposal PDF.

Published / record date: 2026-09. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Pages 3, 6-8; finances, alternatives and timetable

Inspection: Web page / indexed source text inspected

https://www.richmond.gov.uk/media/fxhbilws/kew_riverside_consultation_leaflet.pdf

Used in: CTX

Source register continued

S21: Kew Riverside proposal page

Parent-led Kew Riverside evidence hub. Secondary project context.

Published / record date: Checked 2026-09-22. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Current consultation stage and response deadline; live HTML retrieved

Inspection: Live HTML retrieved

<https://ystoneman.github.io/kew-riverside-website/proposal.html>

Used in: CTX

S22: Kew Riverside establishment record

Department for Education, GIAS. Primary register.

Published / record date: Checked 2026-09-22. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Community-school type and establishment status

Inspection: Direct GIAS HTML retrieval

<https://get-information-schools.service.gov.uk/Establishments/Establishment/Details/133343>

Used in: X06, CTX

S23: STP656: St Bartholomew's CofE Primary School, Brighton

Office of the Schools Adjudicator. Primary determination.

Published / record date: 2024-06-14. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Title page; paragraphs 47-49 and 79-91; PDF pages 15-16 and 23-25

Inspection: Direct PDF retrieval and text inspection

https://assets.publishing.service.gov.uk/media/66ba1d0ba3c2a28abb50e040/STP656_St_Bartholomew_s_CofE_Primary_School_Brighton_and_Hove_14_June_2024.pdf

Used in: F03, F03-E1, F03-E2, X07, L02

S24: Proposed closure of Broad Oak: Lead Member report and appendices

East Sussex County Council. Primary council report (recommendation, not minutes).

Published / record date: 2020-03-09. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Sections 12.1-12.13 and 14-15; budget analysis PDF pages 17-19 (report pages 13-15)

Inspection: Direct PDF retrieval and text inspection

<https://democracy.eastsussex.gov.uk/documents/g4574/Public%20reports%20pack%2009th-Mar-2020%2010.30%20Lead%20Member%20for%20Education%20and%20Inclusion%20Special%20Education.pdf?T=10>

Used in: F02, F02-E1, F02-E2, X07, L01

Source register continued

S25: School Estate Strategy Review: Cabinet report for 11 December 2023

Hackney Council. Primary council report.

Published / record date: 2023-12-11. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Sections 4.24-4.28 (PDF pages 10-11) and 7.10-7.15 (pages 37-38)

Inspection: Direct PDF retrieval and text inspection

<https://hackney.moderngov.co.uk/documents/s86125/CE%20S283%20School%20Estate%20Strategy%20Review.pdf>

Used in: F04, F04-E1, X07, H01

S26: School closures/mergers in September 2024: decision overview

Hackney Education. Primary council decision summary.

Published / record date: Decision 2023-12-11; page undated. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Overview of decision process; De Beauvoir and Randal Cremer closures

Inspection: Web page / indexed source text inspected

<https://education.hackney.gov.uk/content/school-closures-mergers-2023>

Used in: F04, X07

S27: School Place Planning: Cabinet March 2025 report, with addendum

Isle of Wight Council. Primary council report.

Published / record date: 2025-03-20. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Paragraphs 90-94, PDF page 25; paragraph 92 has the six online petition counts

Inspection: Direct PDF retrieval and text inspection

<https://iow.moderngov.co.uk/documents/s17805/5a%2B-%2BSchool%2BPlace%2BPlanning%2B-%2BCabinet%2BMarch%2B2025%2B-V2%2Bwith%2Baddendum.pdf>

Used in: F01, F01-E1, X07, X08, L03

S28: School place planning: action taken during 2024-2025

Isle of Wight Council. Primary council follow-up.

Published / record date: Undated; describes 2024-2025 actions. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Heading: What action has been taken by the Local Authority to address this issue so far? Cowes closure confirmed

Inspection: Web page / indexed source text inspected

<https://www.iow.gov.uk/article/2369/School-place-planning>

Used in: F01, X03, X07, X08, L03

Source register continued

S29: Cowes Primary School: statutory notice

Isle of Wight Council. Primary statutory notice.

Published / record date: 2025-01; representation period ends 2025-02-03. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Paragraphs 2-3: roll, capacity and stated closure grounds

Inspection: Web page / indexed source text inspected

<https://iow.moderngov.co.uk/documents/s17513/Appendix%2017%20-%20Cowes%20Primary%20School%20-%20Statutory%20Notices.pdf>

Used in: F01, X07

S30: Cabinet to decide next week on the proposals to close or merge schools in Hackney

Hackney Council. Primary council explanation; interested decision-maker.

Published / record date: 2023-12-07. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: Consultation totals and rationale for proceeding despite opposition; precise response denominator in S25 section 4.27

Inspection: Web page / indexed source text inspected

<https://news.hackney.gov.uk/news/cabinet-to-decide-next-week-on-the-proposals-to-close-or-merge-schools-in-hackney>

Used in: F04, F04-E2, X07, H01

G01: Fletching Church of England Primary School: establishment record

Department for Education, GIAS. Primary register.

Published / record date: Checked 2026-09-22. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: URN 114503; establishment status, type and linked establishments

Inspection: Direct GIAS HTML retrieval

<https://get-information-schools.service.gov.uk/Establishments/Establishment/Details/114503>

Used in: G-R01

G02: Godshill Primary School: establishment record

Department for Education, GIAS. Primary register.

Published / record date: Checked 2026-09-22. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: URN 118159; establishment status, type and linked establishments

Inspection: Direct GIAS HTML retrieval

<https://get-information-schools.service.gov.uk/Establishments/Establishment/Details/118159>

Used in: G-R02

Source register continued

G03: Brading Church of England Controlled Primary School: establishment record

Department for Education, GIAS. Primary register.

Published / record date: Checked 2026-09-22. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: URN 118182; establishment status, type and linked establishments

Inspection: Direct GIAS HTML retrieval

<https://get-information-schools.service.gov.uk/Establishments/Establishment/Details/118182>

Used in: G-R03

G04: Oakfield Church of England Aided Primary School, Ryde: establishment record

Department for Education, GIAS. Primary register.

Published / record date: Checked 2026-09-22. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: URN 118193; establishment status, type and linked establishments

Inspection: Direct GIAS HTML retrieval

<https://get-information-schools.service.gov.uk/Establishments/Establishment/Details/118193>

Used in: G-R04

G05: Wroxall Primary School: establishment record

Department for Education, GIAS. Primary register.

Published / record date: Checked 2026-09-22. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: URN 118173; establishment status, type and linked establishments

Inspection: Direct GIAS HTML retrieval

<https://get-information-schools.service.gov.uk/Establishments/Establishment/Details/118173>

Used in: G-R05

G06: Arreton St George's Church of England (Aided) Primary School: establishment record

Department for Education, GIAS. Primary register.

Published / record date: Checked 2026-09-22. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: URN 118180; establishment status, type and linked establishments

Inspection: Direct GIAS HTML retrieval

<https://get-information-schools.service.gov.uk/Establishments/Establishment/Details/118180>

Used in: G-R06

Source register continued

G07: St John the Divine Church of England Primary School: establishment record

Department for Education, GIAS. Primary register.

Published / record date: Checked 2026-09-22. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: URN 100614; establishment status, type and linked establishments

Inspection: Direct GIAS HTML retrieval

<https://get-information-schools.service.gov.uk/Establishments/Establishment/Details/100614>

Used in: G-R07

G08: Fenstanton Primary School: establishment record

Department for Education, GIAS. Primary register.

Published / record date: Checked 2026-09-22. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: URN 100595; establishment status, type and linked establishments

Inspection: Direct GIAS HTML retrieval

<https://get-information-schools.service.gov.uk/Establishments/Establishment/Details/100595>

Used in: G-R08

G09: Holy Trinity Church of England Primary School, Tulse Hill: establishment record

Department for Education, GIAS. Primary register.

Published / record date: Checked 2026-09-22. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: URN 100622; establishment status, type and linked establishments

Inspection: Direct GIAS HTML retrieval

<https://get-information-schools.service.gov.uk/Establishments/Establishment/Details/100622>

Used in: G-R09

G10: St George's Church of England Primary School, Langton Matravers: establishment record

Department for Education, GIAS. Primary register.

Published / record date: Checked 2026-09-22. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: URN 150428; establishment status, type and linked establishments

Inspection: Direct GIAS HTML retrieval

<https://get-information-schools.service.gov.uk/Establishments/Establishment/Details/150428>

Used in: G-R11

Source register continued

G11: Hazlewood Community Primary School: establishment record

Department for Education, GIAS. Primary register.

Published / record date: Checked 2026-09-22. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: URN 108610; establishment status, type and linked establishments

Inspection: Direct GIAS HTML retrieval

<https://get-information-schools.service.gov.uk/Establishments/Establishment/Details/108610>

Used in: G-R12

G12: Cowes Primary School: closed establishment record

Department for Education, GIAS. Primary register.

Published / record date: Checked 2026-09-22. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: URN 118156; closure date 2025-08-31 and establishment status

Inspection: Direct GIAS HTML retrieval

<https://get-information-schools.service.gov.uk/Establishments/Establishment/Details/118156>

Used in: F01, X03, X07, X08, L03

G13: Broad Oak Community Primary School: closed establishment record

Department for Education, GIAS. Primary register.

Published / record date: Checked 2026-09-22. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: URN 114390; closure date 2020-08-31 and establishment status

Inspection: Direct GIAS HTML retrieval

<https://get-information-schools.service.gov.uk/Establishments/Establishment/Details/114390>

Used in: F02, X07, L01

G14: St Bartholomew's CofE Primary School: closed establishment record

Department for Education, GIAS. Primary register.

Published / record date: Checked 2026-09-22. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: URN 114538; closure date 2024-12-31 and establishment status

Inspection: Direct GIAS HTML retrieval

<https://get-information-schools.service.gov.uk/Establishments/Establishment/Details/114538>

Used in: F03, X07, L02

Source register continued

G15: De Beauvoir Primary School: closed establishment record

Department for Education, GIAS. Primary register.

Published / record date: Checked 2026-09-22. Accessed: 2026-09-22.

Locator: URN 100224; closure date 2024-08-31 and establishment status

Inspection: Direct GIAS HTML retrieval

<https://get-information-schools.service.gov.uk/Establishments/Establishment/Details/100224>

Used in: F04, X07

Evidence and interpretation ledger

R01 | Fletching Church of England Primary School

Recorded evidence

Consultation halted. The council's recommendation relied on an improved short-term budget, a largely maintained roll and the diocese's position. Its subsequent admissions report confirms that closure did not proceed.

S01 | S02

S01 sections 3.10, 6.4 and 7.1-7.6; S02 section 2.3

G-R01 | Fletching Church of England Primary School - register follow-up

Recorded evidence

Open in GIAS on 22 September 2026

G01

Establishment status and linked establishments, checked 22 September 2026

R02 | Godshill Primary School

Recorded evidence

Removed before statutory notice. Cabinet retained the school, citing community interests, the rural-school presumption and earlier decisions concerning Chillerton and Godshill.

S03 | S04

December Cabinet outcome; S04 response explaining Godshill's removal

G-R02 | Godshill Primary School - register follow-up

Recorded evidence

Open in GIAS on 22 September 2026

G02

Establishment status and linked establishments, checked 22 September 2026

R03 | Brading Church of England Controlled Primary School

Recorded evidence

Closure not pursued. Cabinet voted not to proceed. Published minutes record scrutiny and questions about costs and data, but do not isolate the reason for this school's outcome.

S05

Cabinet item 101a and item 104

G-R03 | Brading Church of England Controlled Primary School - register follow-up

Recorded evidence

Open in GIAS on 22 September 2026

G03

Establishment status and linked establishments, checked 22 September 2026

COMPLETE CITATIONS APPENDIX / CLAIMS

Claim ledger continued

R04 | Oakfield Church of England Aided Primary School, Ryde

Recorded evidence

Closure not pursued. Cabinet voted not to proceed. The minutes document the outcome without a school-specific causal explanation.

S05 | S06

S05 Cabinet item 101a; S06 account of the diocesan challenge

G-R04 | Oakfield Church of England Aided Primary School, Ryde - register follow-up

Recorded evidence

Open in GIAS on 22 September 2026

G04

Establishment status and linked establishments, checked 22 September 2026

R05 | Wroxall Primary School

Recorded evidence

Closure not pursued. Cabinet voted not to proceed. The minutes do not attribute that decision to a particular intervention.

S05

Cabinet items 101a and 104

G-R05 | Wroxall Primary School - register follow-up

Recorded evidence

Open in GIAS on 22 September 2026

G05

Establishment status and linked establishments, checked 22 September 2026

R06 | Arreton St George's Church of England (Aided) Primary School

Recorded evidence

Closure rejected by adjudicator. The adjudicators rejected the proposal because significant procedural flaws could have affected the outcome and the rural community impact had not been properly considered.

S07 | S06

STP661, paragraphs 132-133 and preceding analysis

G-R06 | Arreton St George's Church of England (Aided) Primary School - register follow-up

Recorded evidence

Open in GIAS on 22 September 2026

G06

Establishment status and linked establishments, checked 22 September 2026

Claim ledger continued

R07 | St John the Divine Church of England Primary School

Recorded evidence

Closure/merger proposal rejected. The adjudicator found deficiencies in the process and insufficient evidence that pupil transfers would produce a sustainable receiving school.

S08 | S09

STP659, paragraphs 44-61 and 68

G-R07 | St John the Divine Church of England Primary School - register follow-up

Recorded evidence

Open in GIAS on 22 September 2026

G07

Establishment status and linked establishments, checked 22 September 2026

R08 | Fenstanton Primary School

Recorded evidence

Closure proposal rejected. The adjudicators rejected the closure and related amalgamation proposals because the decisions and procedures were unlawful.

S10

STP662, paragraphs 29-39

G-R08 | Fenstanton Primary School - register follow-up

Recorded evidence

Open in GIAS on 22 September 2026

G08

Establishment status and linked establishments, checked 22 September 2026

R09 | Holy Trinity Church of England Primary School, Tulse Hill

Recorded evidence

Closure proposal rejected. The same adjudication left both Holy Trinity and Fenstanton open after rejecting the linked proposals.

S10

STP662, paragraphs 29-39

G-R09 | Holy Trinity Church of England Primary School, Tulse Hill - register follow-up

Recorded evidence

Open in GIAS on 22 September 2026

G09

Establishment status and linked establishments, checked 22 September 2026

Claim ledger continued

R10 | Pooles Park Primary School

Recorded evidence

Academy route retained; provision continued. The minister retained the academy order. The recorded rationale was a willing sponsor, a viable academy model and additional SEND provision and community benefits.

S11 | S12

2024 High Court judgment, paragraphs 1 and 52-53; GIAS successor URN 150522

G-R10 | Pooles Park Primary School - register follow-up

Recorded evidence

Academy successor open in GIAS on 22 September 2026

S12

Establishment status and linked establishments, checked 22 September 2026

R11 | St George's Church of England Primary School, Langton Matravers

Recorded evidence

Consultation stopped; two-year reprieve reported. News reports quote the trust ending consultation following feedback and ruling out structural changes in 2026/27 and 2027/28.

S13 | S14

Trust statements reported 26-27 June 2026

G-R11 | St George's Church of England Primary School, Langton Matravers - register follow-up

Recorded evidence

Open in GIAS on 22 September 2026

G10

Establishment status and linked establishments, checked 22 September 2026

R12 | Hazlewood Community Primary School

Recorded evidence

Merger rejected; renewed closure proposal reported. The adjudicator rejected the proposed merger but found that, without replacement-building capital, the school should eventually close.

S15 | S16

STP663, paragraphs 67-74; BBC syndicated report 15 September 2026

G-R12 | Hazlewood Community Primary School - register follow-up

Recorded evidence

Open in GIAS on 22 September 2026; renewed proposal reported

G11

Establishment status and linked establishments, checked 22 September 2026

Claim ledger continued

F01 | Cowes Primary School

Recorded evidence

Closure approved by Cabinet; GIAS confirms closure on 31 August 2025. The statutory notice cited declining pupil numbers at Cowes and significant surplus places in its planning area. Cabinet approved closure. The minutes do not establish the marginal effect of the petition or the councillor's intervention.

[S05](#) | [S27](#) | [S28](#) | [S29](#) | [G12](#)

S05 item 101a; S27 paragraph 92; S29 paragraphs 2-3; S28 action taken; G12 closure date

F01-E1 | Cowes Primary School - effort 1

Recorded evidence

An online petition to save the school had 479 signatures in the council's reported initial-consultation snapshot.

[S27](#)

Paragraph 92, PDF page 25

F01-E2 | Cowes Primary School - effort 2

Recorded evidence

The local councillor spoke on behalf of Cowes Primary at the Cabinet meeting before leaving the room for the decision.

[S05](#)

Item 101a, minutes

F02 | Broad Oak Community Primary School

Recorded evidence

March 2020 report recommended closure after examining the governors' alternative; GIAS confirms closure on 31 August 2020. The council's report found the pooled budget would still reach a £33,894 deficit in 2021/22. It questioned leadership capacity, absence cover and contingency, and regarded the extra-pupil target as insufficiently evidenced.

[S24](#) | [G13](#)

S24 sections 12.1-12.13, 14-15; G13 closure date

F02-E1 | Broad Oak Community Primary School - effort 1

Recorded evidence

Governors submitted a plan for two classes, restructured leadership and a pooled three-school federation budget.

[S24](#)

Sections 12.1-12.4, PDF pages 17-18 (report pages 13-14)

F02-E2 | Broad Oak Community Primary School - effort 2

Recorded evidence

The plan sought to build enrolment from 40-plus to 70-plus pupils during the next academic year.

[S24](#)

Sections 12.12-12.13, PDF page 19 (report page 15)

Claim ledger continued

F03 | St Bartholomew's CofE Primary School

Recorded evidence

Adjudicators approved closure with a one-term extension, from 31 August to 31 December 2024. GIAS confirms the later closure date. The adjudicators accepted the demographic need to reduce places and considered the deficit, low pupil numbers and concerns over a smaller school's delivery. They found the transition arrangements insufficiently developed for some vulnerable children and extended the timetable.

S23 | G14

S23 paragraphs 2-3, 47-49 and 79-91; G14 closure date

F03-E1 | St Bartholomew's CofE Primary School - effort 1

Recorded evidence

The school proposed reducing its admission number to 20 with staffing changes, and raised federation and phased closure as alternatives.

S23

Paragraphs 47-49, PDF pages 15-16

F03-E2 | St Bartholomew's CofE Primary School - effort 2

Recorded evidence

Governors referred the decision to the adjudicator. The school and diocese argued for more time to support vulnerable pupils' transition.

S23

Title page, paragraph 7(b)(i), and paragraphs 82-89

F04 | De Beauvoir Primary School

Recorded evidence

Cabinet agreed closure in December 2023; GIAS confirms closure on 31 August 2024. The council rejected suggested pairings on grounds including walking distance and whether pupil numbers would stabilise. It maintained that the underlying demand and sustainability problem remained despite extensive opposition.

S25 | S26 | S30 | G15

S25 sections 4.24-4.28 and 7.10-7.15; S26 overview of decision; S30 consultation summary; G15 closure date

F04-E1 | De Beauvoir Primary School - effort 1

Recorded evidence

Consultation produced alternative merger pairings involving De Beauvoir, including Randal Cremer and Princess May.

S25

Sections 7.10-7.12, PDF pages 37-38

Claim ledger continued

F04-E2 | De Beauvoir Primary School - effort 2

Recorded evidence

Across the whole Hackney package, 95% of responses that could be clearly assessed opposed the proposals. This is a programme-wide figure, not a De Beauvoir-only result.

S30

Paragraph beginning 'At the end of the consultation period'

X01 | Exhibit 1: Closure proposals can stop at several stages

Descriptive exhibit / qualitative coding

Three schools were retained during initial consultation, three at a local decision after statutory notice, and six following external intervention. These are counts within a selected catalogue, not national success rates.

S01 | S02 | S03 | S04 | S05 | S06 | S07 | S08 | S09 | S10 | S11 | S12 | S13 | S14 | S15 | S16

data/catalogue.json: schools and stage; GIAS follow-up in G-R01 to G-R12

X02 | Exhibit 2: What the decision records actually say

Descriptive exhibit / qualitative coding

Nine episodes are coded against six factors. Filled squares mean explicit decision rationale; outlined circles mean discussed or part of the route; dashes mean not established. Factors overlap and are not causal effect estimates.

S01 | S02 | S03 | S04 | S05 | S06 | S07 | S08 | S09 | S10 | S11 | S12 | S13 | S14 | S15 | S16

data/catalogue.json: reason_episodes, values and coding_notes

X03 | Exhibit 3: Six schools. Four routes through one local programme.

Descriptive exhibit / qualitative coding

Of six schools, Godshill was removed before statutory notice; Brading, Oakfield and Wroxall were retained by Cabinet; Arreton was retained after adjudication; Cowes closed on 31 August 2025. This local cohort is not representative of England.

S03 | S05 | S06 | S07 | S28 | G12

S03/S05 decisions; S07 determination; S28 follow-up; G12 closure date

X04 | Exhibit 4: A stronger forecast is not yet a sustainable budget

Descriptive exhibit / qualitative coding

Original forecasts were minus £5,457, minus £62,138 and minus £145,863. Revised forecasts were £40,920, minus £3,299 and between minus £95,588 and minus £39,338. Support comprised £44,368 raised, £20,000 pledged by a trust and a £10,000 parish resolution.

S01 | S02

S01 sections 3.10, 6.4 and 7.1-7.6; forecasts in data/catalogue.json, fletching_budget

Claim ledger continued

X05 | Exhibit 5: Stopping a proposal is only the first milestone

Descriptive exhibit / qualitative coding

On 30 June 2026 the adjudicator rejected the Hazlewood merger proposal but said closure should follow without capital for replacement buildings. A renewed closure proposal was reported on 15 September 2026. The school remained open in GIAS on 22 September 2026.

S15 | S16

S15 paragraphs 67-74; S16 September 2026 follow-up

X06 | Exhibit 6: Turn support into evidence a decision-maker can use

Editorial synthesis

Start a costed operating plan and audit demand and closure savings. In parallel document effects on families and prepare formal submissions. Seek specialist process advice if a specific issue is evidenced. Historical frequency does not estimate the impact of these actions.

S01 | S07 | S08 | S11 | S17 | S18 | S22

Editorial synthesis; case grounds in R01, R06, R07, R10; current guidance and school type in S17-S18/S22

X07 | Exhibit 7: When an alternative did not keep a school open

Descriptive exhibit / qualitative coding

Cowes had a petition and councillor representation but closed. Broad Oak submitted a federation budget, rejected on financial and delivery grounds. St Bartholomew's proposed a smaller school and pursued adjudication; it obtained one extra term, then closed. De Beauvoir merger suggestions and wider opposition did not change the council's conclusion. These are case observations, not estimates of tactic effectiveness.

S05 | S27 | S28 | S29 | G12 | S24 | G13 | S23 | G14 | S25 | S26 | S30 | G15

F01-F04 and their effort records; source-specific locators below

X08 | Exhibit 8: Petition counts do not reveal a success threshold

Descriptive exhibit / qualitative coding

Online petition counts were Oakfield 1,258, Brading 702, Godshill 493, Cowes 479, Arreton 445 and Wroxall 394. Cowes closed in August 2025; the other five proposals stopped. Paper signatures are recorded separately and not summed. The observations do not identify a petition's causal effect or an effective threshold.

S03 | S05 | S07 | S27 | S28 | G12

S27 paragraph 92, PDF page 25; data/unsuccesful-cases.json, petition_snapshot; outcome decisions and follow-up

L01 | A financial alternative

Editorial inference; not a causal estimate

Test every year of the plan and show credible staffing, reserves, pupil demand and partner commitments.

S01 | S02 | S24 | G13

See the paired case records and their source locators

Claim ledger continued

L02 | External challenge

Editorial inference; not a causal estimate

Tie each challenge to a specific defect and its practical remedy. A delay and a lasting reprieve are different outcomes.

[S08](#) | [S23](#) | [G14](#)

See the paired case records and their source locators

L03 | Public mobilisation

Editorial inference; not a causal estimate

Use mobilisation to recruit evidence, expertise and commitments. These observations do not measure whether petitions helped.

[S03](#) | [S05](#) | [S07](#) | [S27](#) | [S28](#) | [G12](#)

See the paired case records and their source locators

CTX | Kew context and current process

Context, not a legal finding about Richmond

Kew is a community school; the project describes initial consultation. Check current guidance and school-specific eligibility before relying on a historic route.

[S17](#) | [S18](#) | [S19](#) | [S20](#) | [S21](#) | [S22](#)

S17 pages 15-18/21-23; S18 applicability; S19-S21 consultation; S22 school type

H01 | Hackney consultation denominator

Recorded evidence

The reported 95% is rounded from 207 opposed out of 219 clear proposal-level responses. There were 175 submissions and people could address multiple proposals.

[S25](#) | [S30](#)

S25 sections 4.24-4.28, PDF pages 10-11. Not a De Beauvoir-only percentage.